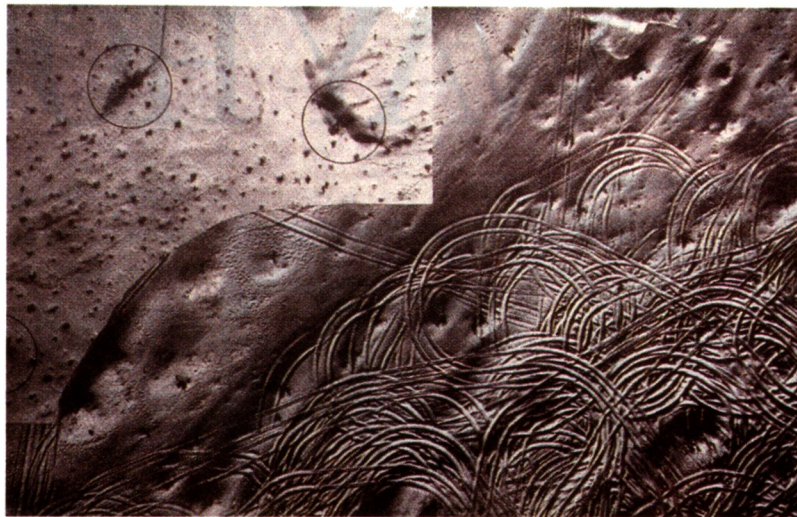


Tanker Trails

In response to Pakistan's pre-emptive air strike, IAF helicopters had transported 1,270 men across river Meghna and brought 40 tonne of equipment in a day. At Longewalla, enemy tankers (right) attempted a breakthrough, but the IAF blocked most of them.



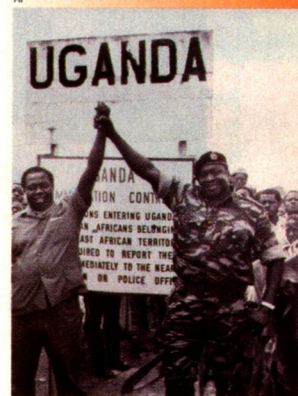
"DACCA IS NOW FREE."

S.H.F.J. Manekshaw

"Dacca is now the free capital of a free country." When Indira Gandhi announced this in Parliament, it was a tribute to Chief of Army Staff Sam Hormusji Framji Jamshedji Manekshaw's war strategy, which resulted in Pakistan's unconditional surrender in the Bangladesh war and 90,000 soldiers being taken as pows. The Indian Army beat back all principal offensives at Poonch, Chhamb and Longewala with heavy losses to the enemy. Decades later, Manekshaw revealed in a BBC interview that in 1970, Indira Gandhi had feared he would stage a military coup. He was awarded the title of Field Marshal in 1973.



- The Bretton Woods System broke down under the deficit spending by the US, which then suspended the convertibility of dollar to gold.
- The Apollo 14 mission sent men to the moon for the third time.
- Idi Amin became president of Uganda after a coup (below), seizing power from Milton Obote, who was responsible for Uganda's independence in 1962.



- Three cosmonauts died on a Soviet space mission, Soyuz 11.

CRICKET CRAZY

In what turned out to be a golden year for Indian cricket, it discovered its greatest batsman, Sunil Gavaskar, as he plundered 774 runs in his debut series as he took India home to its first Test series win in the Caribbean in March. Then, they repeated the feat in England in August.



MERA DIL JO MERA HOTA...

Anubhav portrayed a complex relationship between a busy husband (Sanjeev Kumar) and a neglected wife (Tanuja). Directed by master of middle-class cinema, Basu Bhattacharya, it used minimum supporting characters and background music. The ticking clock heard throughout the film, used as a metaphor for loneliness, made a powerful statement.

3,42,944 was the number of polling stations in the general elections of 1971. The size of the electorate was 275 million and 1,769,802 Indians were on polling duty in the country. There were 66 cases of booth-capturing, as many as 52 of them in Bihar.